Nathan Acks

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Basics

Nathan Acks is a security engineer and penetration tester with over a decade of experience in IT security. His offensive security work spans web applications, thick clients, and mobile applications, blending manual and automated techniques to assess risk, build threat models, and defeat the security mechanisms of the systems he evaluates. He is a deliberate generalist, emphasizing breadth and flexibility of ability rather than single-domain expertise. Nathan develops and leads security trainings, from multi-day sessions for client software development teams to one-on-one workshops on operational security for non-technical staff. Before Bureau Veritas Cybersecurity, he helped found the IT & Security Team at The Public Interest Network, a national nonprofit, after six years of project management and data analysis in its digital organizing program.

Technical Proficiency

Pen Testing	Advanced	**Keywords**: Burp Suite, Impacket, Kali Linux, Metasploit, Nmap, Python, Wireshark
Vulnerability Assessments	Advanced	**Keywords**: Investigations & Research, Source Code Review, Threat Modeling
Cybersecurity	Advanced	**Keywords**: Incident Response, Security Solutions, Security Training, Technical Documentation
Compliance	Intermediate	**Keywords**: PCI DSS, Risk Analysis & Management, Security Policy
IT Operations	Advanced	**Keywords**: Linux Administration, Database Administration, Technical Support
Cloud & SaaS	Intermediate	**Keywords**: Amazon Web Services, Google Workspace, Microsoft 365
Leadership	Advanced	**Keywords**: Organizational Leadership, Strategy & Execution, Strategic Business Partnerships
Projects	Advanced	**Keywords**: Technical Project Management, Stakeholder Communication, Service Excellence

Certifications

May 2022 **CompTIA**, ***Security+ (2022 –2025, expired)***

Professional Experience

Feb 2024–Present **Security Engineer II**, ***Bureau Veritas Cybersecurity North America***, https://cybersecurity.bureauveritas.com

- Led penetration tests across web applications, mobile applications, and network infrastructure, including cloud architecture and AWS account configuration reviews.
- Performed source code review across large multi-repository codebases.
- Wrote client-facing deliverables including architecture and configuration review reports.
- Developed and led multi-day security trainings for client software development teams, delivered on-site in the US and Europe.
- Led teams of 1 - 4 engineers during multi-week engagements covering multiple services and applications.
- Coordinated scoping calls and process improvements as a technical project manager for a major global client.
- Developed in-house tools to aid penetration test automation and effectiveness.
- Notable achievements include:
  - Developed a standardized testing environment using Nix flakes.
  - Maintained an offline knowledge base for use by engineers during on-site engagements without direct internet access.

May 2022–Feb 2024 **Security Engineer I**, ***Bureau Veritas Cybersecurity North America***, https://cybersecurity.bureauveritas.com

- Performed security reviews and penetration tests of web applications, thick clients, and mobile applications as part of an application security team.
- Created threat models that resulted in more secure application design.
- Wrote client-facing deliverables including penetration test reports.
- Analyzed and presented results of testing to team members, managers, and customers.

Jun 2016–May 2022 **Director of IT**, ***The Public Interest Network***, https://publicinterestnetwork.org

- Founded and oversaw the IT & Security team, which grew from one to two, crafting organization-wide security policies, documentation, and trainings with the Legal team and the President's Office.
- Held bottom-line responsibility for the roll-out, maintenance, security, and support of IT systems used by 150 - 200 staff (up to 500 in summer), including email, authentication, document management, and custom internal applications.
- Served as the technical point-of-contact for PCI DSS issues.
- Investigated and remediated potential IT security incidents.
- Notable achievements include:
  - Oversaw the creation of an internal account lifecycle system covering Okta, Google Workspace, Microsoft 365, and Zoom, including just-in-time Zoom provisioning driven by shared calendar bookings.
  - Oversaw migrations from a legacy vendor email system to Google Workspace and from legacy LDAP to Okta.
  - Managed the roll-out of two-factor authentication to all staff and the migration of office phones to Zoom Phone.

Oct 2009–Jun 2016 **Manager of Online Outreach Technology**, ***The Public Interest Network***, https://publicinterestnetwork.org

- Provided data analysis, database development, and IT vendor management for the organization's digital organizing program.
- Managed up to five Linux servers running mission-critical applications including LDAP/GOsa, MySQL, NFS, Postfix, Apache, CiviCRM, WebGUI, and Tenable Security Center.
- Maintained a library of dozens of custom SQL and PL/SQL scripts for reporting and data import, export, and clean-up.
- Participated in outreach strategy development and helped write content for email campaigns and web pages, including rapid responses to breaking political stories.
- Notable achievements include:
  - Oversaw the migrations of an in-house constituent relationship management (CRM) and action system to a vendor CRM (Convio, and later Salsa).
  - Led a project that integrated vendor CRM databases with a separate system hosted by ROI Solutions.

Education

Apr 2005–May 2009 **Master, Applied Mathematics**, ***University of Colorado, Denver, CO***, https://ucdenver.edu

Jul 1999–Dec 2003 **Bachelor, Theoretical Physics**, ***University of Colorado, Denver, CO***, https://ucdenver.edu

Community Involvement

Apr 2020–Present **Yakshaver**, ***Yak Collective***, https://www.yakcollective.org

- Maintained a static website for the organization using Quartz, GitHub Actions, and Netlify.
- Wrote and maintained organization-specific Discord bots hosted using exe.dev.
- Helped design and implement externally-facing project pages.
- Part of the core team responsible for managing the organizational treasury using Gnosis Safe.